越狱的章鱼

The Octopus That Escaped



章鱼的聪明，等于拥有意识吗？

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英文原文

One night in early 2016, after keepers at New Zealand's National Aquarium in Napier had left, an octopus named Inky crept through an aperture in the mesh atop its tank. The fugitive presumably dropped to the floor, crossed the room, and compressed its elastic body into a drain, whose pipe stretched some 50 metres to the Pacific.

Staff reconstructed that route from the slime residue it deposited. Inky had resided in captivity since 2014, when a fisherman retrieved it from a crayfish pot off Napier. The breakout went unreported for about three months. Made public in April 2016, the story travelled the globe.

Such agility stems from an octopus's pliable body, which has no skeleton or shell. Its only hard part is its beak, so any crevice that accommodates the beak will do. Roughly two-thirds of its 500 million neurons lie in the limbs, which handle sensory input and react with some autonomy.

Its wits are as versatile as its anatomy. A giant Pacific octopus in Seattle learned to open screw-top jars, needing 15 minutes at the outset, later about two. In a 2010 study, octopuses came to discriminate between two strangers, a feeder and one who touched them with a bristly stick, adopting a different hue and posture for each.

In July 2012 the Cambridge Declaration on Consciousness listed octopuses among animals possessing the neurological substrates for conscious awareness. A November 2021 UK government review recommended treating them as sentient, and the Animal Welfare (Sentience) Act encompassed them in April 2022. None of this proves an inner life. Inky, somewhere beyond the pipe, remained wholly oblivious to the debate.

中文译文

2016年初的一个夜晚，新西兰内皮尔国家水族馆的饲养员离开后，一只名叫Inky的章鱼从水箱顶部网罩的开口悄悄爬了出来。这名“逃脱者”大概先落到地板上，穿过房间，再把柔软而有弹性的身体挤进排水口；那里的管道长约50米，一直通向太平洋。

工作人员根据它留下的黏液痕迹，还原了这条可能的路线。Inky自2014年起便生活在圈养环境中；当时，一名渔民从内皮尔附近海域的捕虾笼中取出了它。这次出逃约三个月都没有见诸报道，直到2016年4月公开后，故事才传遍全球。

章鱼如此敏捷，得益于柔韧的身体：它没有骨骼，也没有外壳，唯一坚硬的部位是喙。所以，只要缝隙能容下喙，身体便能通过。章鱼约5亿个神经元中，大约三分之二分布在腕足里；腕足会处理感觉信息，并能在一定程度上自主作出反应。

它的智力与身体构造一样，表现出多样的能力。西雅图的一只巨型太平洋章鱼学会了打开螺旋盖罐子，最初需要15分钟，后来只需约两分钟。在2010年的一项研究中，章鱼逐渐学会区分两个原本陌生的人：一个给它们喂食，另一个拿硬毛棒碰它们。面对不同的人，它们会呈现不同的颜色和姿态。

2012年7月，《剑桥意识宣言》把章鱼列为具有支撑意识的神经基础的动物之一。2021年11月，英国政府的一份评估报告建议把它们视为有感知能力的动物；2022年4月，《动物福利（感知）法》也将它们纳入适用范围。然而，这些都不能证明章鱼拥有主观的内在体验。在管道另一头某处的Inky，依然对人们的这场争论一无所知。

核心词汇

先记这22项。连着下方的原文短语一起回想。

aperture n.
开口；孔隙
an aperture in the mesh

presumably adv.
据推测；大概
fugitive presumably dropped

compress v.
压缩；挤压
and compressed its elastic body

reconstruct v.
根据线索还原
reconstructed that route

residue n.
残留物；痕迹
slime residue it deposited.

captivity n.
圈养；囚禁状态
in captivity since 2014,

agility n.
敏捷；灵活
Such agility

pliable adj.
柔韧的；易弯曲的
octopus's pliable body,

crevice n.
窄缝；裂隙
crevice that accommodates the beak

neuron n.
神经元
neurons lie in the limbs

sensory input n.
感觉信息；感官输入
handle sensory input

autonomy n.
自主性
react with some autonomy.

versatile adj.
多才多能的；功能多样的
as versatile as its anatomy.

anatomy n.
身体构造
as versatile as its anatomy

discriminate v.
区分；辨别
to discriminate between two strangers,

hue n.
颜色；色调
different hue and posture

posture n.
姿态
a different hue and posture

neurological adj.
神经系统的
the neurological substrates

substrate n.
活动所依托的物质基础
neurological substrates

awareness n.
意识；觉察
conscious awareness.

sentient adj.
有感知能力的
as sentient,

oblivious adj.
对……毫不知情的
wholly oblivious to the debate.

文中词汇与搭配

补充词汇共30项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

keeper n.
饲养员

creep v.
悄悄爬行

mesh n.
网；网罩

atop prep.
在……顶部

fugitive n.
逃脱者；逃亡者

elastic adj.
有弹性的

stretch v.
延伸

slime n.
黏液

deposit v.
留下；沉积

reside v.
居住；栖居

retrieve v.
取出；取回

crayfish pot n.
捕虾笼

breakout n.
逃脱；越狱

unreported adj.
未被报道的

globe n.
全球；世界

stem from phr. v.
源于

skeleton n.
骨骼

beak n.
喙

accommodate v.
容纳

limb n.
肢体；此处指腕足

wits n.
智力；机智

jar n.
罐子

at the outset phr.
起初

feeder n.
喂食者

adopt v.
采取；呈现

possess v.
具有；拥有

conscious adj.
有意识的

encompass v.
涵盖；纳入

inner adj.
内在的；内心的

wholly adv.
完全地

回想与回顾

先遮住下方答案，再把四个词放回原文。

01 Staff _____ that route from the slime residue it deposited.

02 Such _____ stems from an octopus's pliable body, which has no skeleton or shell.

03 Roughly two-thirds of its 500 million neurons lie in the limbs, which handle sensory input and react with some _____.

04 Inky, somewhere beyond the pipe, remained wholly _____ to the debate.

文章主线

- 出逃 章鱼Inky逃出水箱；工作人员据黏液痕迹推测，它钻入通向海洋的约50米排水管。
- 身体 章鱼没有骨骼和外壳；只要坚硬的喙能通过，柔软的身体就能挤过缝隙。
- 能力 章鱼约5亿个神经元中，约三分之二位于腕足，腕足可部分自主反应；章鱼还能学会开罐、区分喂食者与拿刺毛棒碰它的人。
- 认定 2012年《剑桥意识宣言》认为章鱼具有意识的神经基础；英国2022年法律也将章鱼视为有感知动物。
- 限度 这些仍不能直接证明章鱼确有内心体验。

参考答案　1 reconstructed 2 agility 3 autonomy 4 oblivious